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HISTORICAL AND PHILOSOPHICAL SOURCES OF THE EMERGENCE AND DEVELOPMENT OF THE CONCEPT OF "ENERGY"

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Annotation. *In the article, the author explores the historical and theoretical sources of the emergence and development of the concept of "energy". Particular attention is paid to the Aristotelian interpretation, which is crucial in the formation of non-classical ontology. An analysis of this approach allows us to refute the established opinion that Neoplatonism was the source of energy ontology, and hence the philosophical and theological teaching of Eastern Christianity is Christianized Neoplatonism.*

Key words: *energy; Entelechy; essence; activity; reality, Synergy, Ontology, non-classical paradigm.*

Introduction. In the famous lectures collection "Energy" V. Bibikhin points to the "energy" concept as a key value in the modern history. From basic to applied sciences in Natural science to technical, economic and humanitarian spheres the "Energy" concept is refracted, but not diminished. "Energy is like that God who is to give the world the first impetus, upon which something begins to happen in the world" (4, p. 24).

In the XIX -XX centuries, many thinkers of different spheres made this concept the basis for modern science. Nevertheless, V. Bibikhin states definitely: "We have not defined the Energy". Moreover, the researcher further attacks one of the most fundamental achievements of dogmatic Christianity: "The most unworked dogma in Orthodoxy remains the 14th-century Palamite definition of Divinity and divine Energies. This is the most recent of all the dogmatic definitions of the Orthodox Church, rejected by the Western Church. We cannot at all claim that we have fully clarified the Aristotelian Energy; in fact, we did not even really approach it. Therefore, it is not at all the case that, as if armed with the philosophical concept of Energy, we now want to clarify the Energy of Christian dogmatic. All the same, nothing would have happened, because Dogmatics is a different element than Philosophy. It would be easier, of course, to state that "and the concept of Energy has also been broken in Orthodox dogmatic, but we are busy with our philosophical studying, and it doesn't matter"; but it does matter, for two reasons: the theme of Energies already exists in Russian thought and has taken a noticeable place in it; and Orthodox theology has left us the dogma of Divine energies for comprehension, because it itself does not seem to undertake this work" (4, p. 95).

V. Bibikhin's opponent S. Horujy, who considers the "Energy" in the context of the Philosophical and Religious paradigm not only of historical Christianity, but also

of modernity, is also unambiguous in his definition: “The Energy discourse has not yet received a developed Philosophical expression, nor in the Western tradition (where the Essential philosophy prevailed), nor in the Eastern tradition (where the Theological form of expression prevailed, and often non-verbal forms)” (19, p. 17).

Here we are faced with a paradox. The degree of this concept elaboration has a wide range almost in all spheres of modern science, but on the other hand, the Ontological status of “Energy” in modern Fundamental philosophy remains not comprehended, which itself defines the border, boundary, the “fold” between the Classical and Non-classical philosophical paradigm.

The proceeding to attempt to develop a Post-non-classical paradigm, as if overcoming the Non-classical one, is a Historical and Philosophical underestimation of Energy ontology, which today has taken a central place not only in the Scientific and theoretical or Scientific and practical, but also in social existence.

To find the historical and philosophical sources for the formation and development of the Ontological non-classical paradigm and the reasons for underestimating the concept of the energetic ontology of the Western European classical tradition.

Methods. For this purpose we will use the historical and genetically constructive method, which would allow us to investigate the sources for the “Energy” concept formation. Among the modern studies that differ in the systematic of detailed elaboration of this concept, we will rely on the work of D. Bradshaw “Aristotle East and West: Metaphysics and the Division of Christendom”.

As the author notes, the origin of the “Energy” term itself is hidden by history. Nevertheless, D. Bradshaw claims that in the Greek literature that has come down to us, this term was not used before Aristotle. And after his death, for several decades, this term was used only among philosophers who belonged to the school of Aristotle himself. In the Stagirite's works, the “Energy” term is used 671 times. “… The simplest sense of the Energeia term lies in the Aristotelian corpus, that is, activity, turns out to be the earliest. The earliest meaning is activity, considered specifically as the realization of the ability in contrast to simple possession” (5, p. 26). Aristotle used the term Entelecheia as a synonym for Energeia. In this case, drawing attention to various hypotheses for the meaning of this concept, the author claims that it is quite obvious that at the root of this word lie “the state of accomplishment” and “being in the fullness” of reality”. Hence it follows that Aristotle created this neologism to indicate the relevance. Apparently it is no coincidence that he has used the word “Dynamis” to denote potentiality. According to D. Bradshaw, the key point here is that Aristotle's Metaphysics is aimed at upholding the priority of reality in relation to possibility. Moreover, reality precedes possibility. For things that exist in reality can exist without those that exist in possibility, but not vice versa. Therefore, reality has priority in essence and precedes the possibility.

The Chapter IX.9 of Metaphysics begins with the assertion that Energeia is “better and more valuable” than even the good potency (1051a4-5). This is an important addition because this is the first time it is said that “Energy” as such possesses value. This argument is simple: every capacity is the capacity for contraries, and in this sense one

must be good and the other evil. As a result, good reality is better than capacity, since the latter includes both good and evil (1051a5-15)" (5, p. 49). Further, Aristotle states that the eternal can't be evil, the eternal must be free from evil. Consequently, the Aristotle's "energy" is the reality, the beginning that exists by itself, the Unmoved mover. This is a very important remark because it became important for the later Neoplatonism thinkers, who had already conceptually developed the "energy" concept.

At the same time, in the process of forming the Unmoved mover theory, Aristotle relies not only on philosophical, but also on unspoken theological premises. "And life is truly inherent in him, for the activity of the mind is life, and God is activity; and his activity, as it is in itself, is the best and eternal life. Therefore, we say that God is an eternal, best living being, so that life and continuous and eternal existence are inherent in him, and this is precisely what God is" (1, p. 276).

D. Bradshaw makes an interesting conclusion that distinguishes his thought from the classical understanding: "Aristotle's God is simultaneously transcendent and immanent: transcendental as existing eternally in complete reality, but immanent as a constituent for the formal and target causes - and therefore also the acting cause - of natural changes" (5, p. 74). Thus, it was Aristotle who laid the broadest possibility of various theoretical connotations, which to this day have a fan of uncertainties.

"We have not defined Energy," writes V. Bibikhin, "Energy is power: this is not a definition yet, because we will then imperceptibly define power as Energy. ... The fact that we do not define energy, we unexpectedly coincide with Aristotle: he does not define it either" (4, p. 26).

Now it is very important to pay attention to how both the contemporaries of Aristotle and the philosophers of the next generation understood "energy". And then it turns out that this term is not found either in Speusipus, or in Xenocrates, or in representatives of the Hellenistic schools. "It is not found in any of the most significant authors of the III - early II centuries BC. - Menander, Kallimachus, Apolonius of Rhodes; it is not found in the Septugian, as well as in many less noticeable figures, including the nephew of Aristotle himself - the historian Callisthenes of Olinthus" (5, p. 85).

The first use of the term "Energy" is found in the Democritus's - in Nevsifan of Theos, the fragment of which is apparently taken from the popular work of Aristotle "Protrepticus ". Nevsifan's disciple Epicurus also uses this source. To say the true, he, using Aristotelian terminology, comes to the opposite conclusions in relation to Aristotle.

But according to Diogenes Laertius and Sextus Empiricus, the Stoics quite often used the term "Energy". However, the Hellenistic schools do not provide enough deep material for the history of "energy". Strabo and Plutarch left us information that after the death of Aristotle, his books passed to Theophrastus, a disciple and second head of Lyceum. Among the peripatetics themselves, the term "energy" fell into oblivion already after the death of Theophrastus. Theophrastus gave these books to Neleus of Skepsis. Then in the II century BC they are found and published in the damaged form in Athens by a certain Apellikon. And only in the middle of the 1st century BC the first revised edition of Andronicus of Rhodes appears. But even the published edition did not arouse

much interest in the term “energy”.

Among the historical writings “Historical Library” by Diodorus Siculus should be noted, which was written ca. 60-30 years BC. The word Energy is used not only in the sense of activity and the power associated with it, but in the sense of the nature of the person activity, society over a long period of time. In relation to a person, this word is translated as “power”, “energy”, and in relation to society as “practice”, “custom”, in relation to a thing – “influence”, “operation”.

As D. Bradshaw states, "the first scientific use" belongs to Thessalus, who lived in the 1st century BC. In the treatise “De Virtutibus Herbarum” the author writes about the healing power of plants. It was at this time that the “energy” concept became recognized in the scientific community.

Among the philosophers of the first two centuries AD the use and interest to the “energy” concept arose among the middle Platonists. The innovation in the scientific context belongs to Galen, who wrote in the II century. First, Galen distinguishes between “energies” of capacities of body and soul that lend themselves to knowledge and their essence (ousiai), which is impossible to know. But most importantly, Galen says about the triad that makes up dynamys with its knowable energeia and unknowable ousia. The theological application of this triad became widespread among the Neoplatonists and the Church Fathers.

Philo of Alexandria (c. 30 BC - 45 AD) is attributed to a number of middle Platonists. And, although Philo himself really points to the influence of Plato, he explains this by the fact that Plato is more successful than anyone from the Greeks expressed what was said by Moses. Philo often uses the term “Energy” in the sense of “activity”. Especially when it concerns the activity of the mind, feeling, part of the body. But Philo's important innovations with regard to the term “Energy” concern theology. With all the influence of Aristotelian thought, it is necessary to pay attention to the fact that if for Aristotle the eternal activity of the beginning is, in fact, thinking that thinks about itself, then for Philo the God's activity is creation, constructing. “God eternally creates through eternal thinking directed at Ideas that give the form to matter. And although in the work “De Providentia” the eternal creative thinking of God is not actually called His “energy”, there are all the components that allow one to come to such an identification” (5, p. 98).

Given that, like Aristotle, Philo claims that eternal activity is not work, but peace, nevertheless, for Philo, Energy, in fact, belongs only to God. In addition, Philo does not restrict the God's activity to thinking that thinks about itself, but considers God as the activity in a personal aspect. At the same time, he clearly distinguishes between the divine essence, which man is not able to know and the fact of the existence of God through divine powers. Thus, Philo opposes the energy of divine powers and their unknowable ousia. Therefore, in the strict sense of the word, Philo cannot be called a Platonist. But, although Philo distinguishes between the divine essence and powers, and in this sense he pursues the same goal as the Church Fathers, but, nevertheless, the knowledge obtained through powers, for Philo, is the result of inferences. And this is far from what the Greek Fathers had in mind when they spoke about knowledge through divine “Energies”.

So, Aristotle was the first to state that it is God who discovers Energy. “The difference is that Aristotle meant mainly “energy as reality, while Philo”-“energy” as activity” (5, p. 100). It is this approach that makes it possible to interpret “energy” as a way of knowing God.

The idea of divine activity can be traced further with the Middle Platonists Numenius and Alcinoy. But unlike them, it is the peripatetic of the early empire, Alexander Aphrodis, who expresses his views in terms of “energy” and thus places this concept at the center of philosophical reflection. While holding the post of professor of Aristotelian philosophy (198 - 209 A.D.), he could be exactly the one to whom Plotinus listened to. In any case, Alexander influenced on the Plotinus formation.

Of course, Plotinus is the founder of Neoplatonism, and thus Plato had the greatest influence on him. However, Plotinus's creative talent was not prevented by precisely the Aristotelian “energy” concept from using not at all in an Aristotelian sense. This concerns the theory of two acts in his famous Enneads. The problem posed by Plotinus concerned how the Mind comes from the One, if we consider that the One itself is perfect, and therefore does not need anything. Plotinus begins with the fact that perfection within oneself has the ability to create, to born. “But we can see that here, in the sublunary world, as soon as a Being reaches maturity and fullness of strength, it does not remain sterile, but gives birth and produces something else; and this is observed not only in Beings endowed with the ability of conscious will-determination, but also in things lacking this ability, even in soulless things, which also often spread the actions of their powers outside themselves, as, for example, fire warms other things, snow or ice - cool, medicinal herbs and juices also have this or that effect. In this case, all things, as it were, imitate, to the best of their ability, the First Principle, as if striving to manifest in themselves its eternity and goodness” (13, V.4.1.26 - 36). Plotinus speaks quite definitely about the Good's creative nature, but this was not the main challenge for Platonism. In middle Platonism, the first Good is the Divine Mind. Plotinus is trying to say that Mind cannot be the source of all things. If the Mind is identical to mental activity, then mental activity is determined by the contemplated object, which determines the very mental activity. That is why Mind, “nous”, cannot in any way be the source of all things, but, on the contrary, its object must precede it in the order of existence” (5, p. 115). Therefore, in relation to the Divine Mind, this subject is the One.

And here the most important question arises: how can something come from the One if the One is perfect and unchanging? “Here we have to distinguish the energy of the essence from the energy that flows from the essence. The energy of essence does not differ from the essence to which it belongs, it is always this essence itself. But the energy emanating from the essence differs from it, as from its cause. Each thing possesses both one and the other energy. So, for example, in fire - one is that warmth that constitutes its essence, and quite another - that which spreads from it in all directions; this second energy is generated by the first precisely because it constitutes the very substance of fire and that it is in it that fire itself preserves its nature, that is, it remains like fire” (13, p. (V.4.2.27-39). Here Plotinus introduces two different modes of “energy”- internal and

external, which made up the theory of two actions. Here external action is a way of manifesting the internal structure of a thing. Like heat, which is a manifestation of fire, or cold, as a way of manifesting snow or incense, as a manifestation of a potion. That is, all essences perform external actions. That is, the One, like everything else, possesses both energeia tes ousias and energeia ek tes ousias. To say the true, later Plotinus tries to assert that the One is higher than essence (ousia). But then the question arises - how the One can have two types of energy in itself?

Nevertheless, it is important for Plotinus to explain the other - how the Mind comes from the One. "The mind, which is born from the One, is like the light emanating from it, while the source itself does not change at all from this and remains at rest. In the same way, other things, remaining motionless, produce from their own being outwardly different phenomena, which can be considered as images of the power that produces them, which is their prototype. So, for example, fire spreads around itself heat, ice and snow - cold; the best example can be various aromatic substances that spread around themselves the smell, felt by everyone who is nearby, and with which everything lying nearby is soaked (13, (V.1.6.31 - 48). Plotinus introduces the concept of hypostasis, prototypes, which ontologically, but hierarchically interconnected. Thus, the Soul refers to the Mind as an image to the prototype, where the inner "energy" of the Soul becomes the contemplation of the Mind. In turn, the inner "energy" of the Mind becomes the essence of the One. The One itself cannot be the inner generating energy. The One has only external action. Therefore, from the point of view of the theory of two actions, One is the exception to the rule.

It is interesting that this ontological hierarchy of internal and external "energies" does not apply to Matter for Matter is "absolute uncertainty", which means that it cannot have "Energy". The only reality of it is the passive perception of the form that is given by the Soul.

"Starting from the I century AD and in the following centuries, the term Energeia has taken a special place and interesting evolution. By the IV century, both Pagans and Christians comprehend their religious life as a way of participating in divine "Energy" (5, p. 169). Moreover, this applies in the sense of practical activity.

At the same time, religious authors start to interpret "energy" not as a characteristic of action, which is inherent in Hellenistic authors, but in the sense of the source of power "to which one can join". Initially, this interpretation does not arise from the depths of metaphysics, but at the mass level. But then through Iamblichus and Proclus it penetrates into the philosophical space.

The Jewish text of the II century AD "The Letter of Aristeus to Philocrates" is perhaps the first text where the action of divine "energy" affects not only the universe as a whole, but also a specific human soul.

From amongst the Christian authors, special attention should be paid to the Apostle Paul - the only New Testament author "who speaks about "Energy" and speaks quite often" (5, p. 170). Paul speaks of the cosmic level of divine "energy" (Eph 1: 19-20) through which God raised Christ from the dead. On personal level, divine "Energy" acts

through each member of the Church, which is primarily the body of Christ. In another case, Paul says "It is no longer I who live, but Christ lives in me". Here the divine "energy" acts in a person transforming the whole person. On the other hand, God himself acts through man. In this case, the actions of God remain the own actions of man. So the divine “Energy” is also a person's own “Energy”. Here, the concept of “Synergy”, central in the future Orthodox ontology, arises - the interaction of God and man, as a result, even calling Jesus Lord is possible only through the assistance of the Spirit.

Then Paul takes another very important step, which in the Late antiquity epochwill become the cornerstone for both Christians and Pagans. The most important goal he defines the communion of divine “energies”. Indeed, defining the meaning of spiritual life, Paul is very far from being theoretical, and therefore does not build metaphysical constructions in relation to the divine ousia.

Subsequent generations of Christian authors thought of the divine presence in the sense of the combination of divine and human “Energy”. Nevertheless, they deliberately tried to limit the understanding of this term in the sense of miracles and prophecies and admitted that they could also occur under the influence of demons. For example, Shepherd of Hermas, written between 100 and 150 years, represents the features of human character as the energeiai of the angel of righteousness and the angel of depravity, which accompany every person” (5, p. 173). St. Justin Martyr, Athenagoras also speaks of the “energy” of demons. Clement of Alexandria in “Stromates” speaks of the energies of devil and unclean spirits, which are sown like seeds in the soul of sinner. Origen in the work Against Celsus speaks directly about attracting demonic “energy” with the help of magic. And in the essay “On the First Principles” Origen writes: “The human soul, while in body, can perceive different influences (energias), i.e. the impact of various spirits, evil and good” (17, p. 101).

The cautious attitude of Christian thinkers to Energy can be explained by the great attention of the Hermetic literature. According to Hermeticism, the cosmos is full of Gods and demons who act through “energy”, which is, in fact, one energy. Hermeticism reinterprets Plato's language into Emanational and Pantheistic.

Porfiry (232-305) became the heir to Plotinus and the leader of Neoplatonism. But with regard to the theme of “Energy,” his main works were either lost or used in Plotin's meanings. In the East, the leader of Neoplatonism became Iamblichus (c. 240 -325), whom Proclus called “divine” after Plato and Pythagoras. His treatise “On the Mysteries of the Egyptians” was aimed at defending the religious practices of late paganism. Iamblichus has developed a hierarchy of supernatural beings. A major distinction is made between Gods, who are good in their nature, and human souls, who are good in involvement. Between them are heroes, demigods, who are closer to human souls, but exceeding in strength and virtue, and demons, who are closer to the gods, but they are at the lowest level and are servants of the Gods. Describing theurgy, Iamblichus points to a number of ways to achieve participation in divine ‘Energies’, a kind of magic synthesis and self-knowledge of the true divine being in man is formed.

The followers of Iamblichus in the epoch of Julian (361 - 364), who tried to revive

paganism, had great success and popularity for the Neoplatonic School of Athens. This is especially true of Proclus (412 - 485) and his most famous work “The elements of Theology”. In general, systematically and deductively presented Proclus's neoplatonism has its own peculiarity. And namely, within each “level” (Nature, Soul, Mind, One) Proclus places a certain generative principle, a monad, from which other members emanate and to which they return. That is, the Unity divides into a series of lesser unities – “genads”. So if the Unity is the Good, then each “genad” is a particular mode, “particular goodness”. But genada is not just a property, it is a kind of agent. And since “there is nothing further Beyond The One that toward which all things aspire” (14, p. 84), it can justly be called God. And since the genads have the same transcendental nature, it means they, in fact, also Gods. Thus, the goal of theoretical substantiation of the pantheism of pagan gods is achieved.

The detailed Proclus's hierarchy is formed on the inner striving to become a partaker of the divine “Energy”, which returns, folds into the One, in which Proclus denies “Energy”. However, this involvement demonstrates synergy between the One and the subordinate causes.

But here the question arises - how exactly can the lower undivine souls participate? It turns out that the soul can participate not substantively, but by the involvement of its cause. “The knowledge of the Gods available to him will not be in accordance with the nature of the lower, but corresponding to the exclusive superiority of the Gods beyond him. Therefore, the knowledge [by the Gods] of the plural and enduring is one in appearance and is free of enduring. Therefore, although the knowable is separate, nevertheless the divine knowledge of the separate is inseparable, and although it refers to the changeable, nevertheless it is unchangeable, and although it refers to the accidental, it is nevertheless necessary, and although it refers to the indefinite, nevertheless it is definite. For the divine perceives knowledge not from the lowest, otherwise knowledge would not be what is known by its nature. (14, p. 92-93).

This is a very important moment. For “for Plotinus, all the lower levels of being ascend to Mind, so that, surpassing Mind, you also surpass all other levels of being. In Proclus, Mind no longer occupies the privileged position of the intermediary between the One and other beings. Everything comes directly from the One, and therefore everything must be included in the process of returning to the One in order for the union to be completed in full” (5, p. 206).

Results. In the Middle Ages, most of the texts were unknown in the West. “It is not surprising that the magical papyri, hermetic writings and works of Iamblichus and Proclus were not translated; it is much more surprising that this also applies to the works of Justin Martyr, Athenagoras, Clement of Alexandria, Origen and Athanasius the Great (with the exception of Origen's “On the First Principles” and some exegetical treatises)” (5, p. 209]. It is with this that D. Bradshaw explains negative attitude of the Western European tradition to the theme of “Energy.” The author draws attention to the fact that of all the texts that were analyzed only one, the New Testament, was beyond, which was translated by Jerome. But in it Energeia was translated as Operatio, and Energein - as

Operari. The specific nature of the Latin language did not allow perceiving operationes in the sense of active powers to which a person can join. But what is important is that operatio does not contribute to the association of "energy" with activity, and even more so to the merging of activity with reality. And therefore, when in XII - XIII centuries texts of Aristotle were translated, the term "Energy" in different contexts was conveyed by three different terms: operatio, actus and actualitas. With all variations, these terms did not lead to an awareness of the unity of the concept that underlies these terms.

This was the important reason why the idea of the involvement of divine "Energy" did not take root in the paradigm of Western European thought. In the culture of thinking of the Greek-speaking world, the term "Energy" acquired a metaphysical meaning. The interweaving of metaphysical and religious concepts in hermetic texts, as well as in Iamblichus and Proclus, took place in parallel with Christian authors. And in the IV century, during the period of Trinitarian Controversy, the concept of "Energy" takes a key place and meaning. But it determines the peculiarity of not only the Eastern Christian worldview. Energy ontology becomes the paradigm core of Post-classical modern thinking.

Conclusions. Thus, the Non-classical Energy ontology in the Christian era was formed as a completely independent philosophical paradigm, which was theologically assimilated by Eastern Christianity. And therefore it is quite logical to consider it not a product of Neoplatonism, but an independent discourse completely rooted in antiquity.

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